

Sheela Foam Turns to Zimbra's Advanced Collaboration Platform

"We highly recommend Zimbra to businesses who want to reduce costs without compromising on quality," says **Pertisth Mankotia, head, IT, at Sheela Foam Private Limited**

Sheela Foam

Founded in 1972, Sheela Foam Pvt Ltd is India's largest mattress manufacturer and is ranked among the top five manufacturers of Slabstock PU foam in South East Asia. The firm has 11 manufacturing units using state-of-the-art technology across India and five manufacturing units in Australia. Sheela Foam caters to a wide spectrum of customers through an efficient distribution network of over 100 distributors and 4,500 dealers. Its products include Sleepwell in India and Joyce in Australia. A combination of manufacturing excellence and a wide distribution network has helped it acquire over 40 per cent of the Indian PU foam market.

The opportunity

Because Sheela Foam operates over a distributed geography and has a widespread network, the communication within the distribution channel had to be really quick for the network to work efficiently. The email solution was an area of concern for Sheela Foam's IT department. The team was using a combination of email systems, including Microsoft Exchange. As the business grew, the number of users increased as well, and Sheela Foam began facing issues related to the burgeoning cost of Microsoft Exchange user licences. Sheela Foam's IT team, lead by Pertisth Mankotia, was looking at consolidating the email systems into a single email system that was fast, efficient, cost-effective, user-friendly and scalable. In addition, the team required the email solution to be compatible with a wide range of operating systems.

The solution

The IT team evaluated various email solutions, including Zimbra. The team members were very impressed with the flexibility, scalability and economy Zimbra offered. Its simple licensing (based on mailboxes) offered additional flexibility, compared to the existing set-up.

The Zimbra deployment was done in less than three days, during which 1,100 mailboxes were migrated to it. As Zimbra is available in multiple editions (Starter, Standard and Professional), Sheela Foam was able to offer the Standard edition to non-power users and the Professional edition to power users. This helped Sheela Foam lower licensing costs further, and offer mailboxes to their dealers and distributors as well. The IT team also leveraged Zimbra's collaboration features, such as file sharing, scheduling, instant messaging and the mobile Web client.



INDUSTRY
Manufacturing

CORPORATE HEADQUARTERS
Ghaziabad, India

EMPLOYEES
1,500 +

PRODUCT
Zimbra Collaboration

KEY BENEFITS

- Powerful user experience
- Ease of management
- Flexible licensing
- Cost-effective

The Zimbra team worked very closely with the Sheela Foam team to ensure that the transition was extremely easy. "The team did a great job by providing us with all the support we needed during the transition. The solution has turned out to be a perfect fit for our requirements, with the numerous benefits it offers us in comparison to our earlier set-up," said Mankotia.

The results

Messaging and collaboration made easy: The feature-rich browser-based experience of Zimbra allows users to stay connected securely, anywhere, and to any device or platform. The briefcase feature also allows users to share large files. Zimlets gives users the ability to integrate third-party applications into the email client, thereby enhancing productivity and the user experience.

Simple licensing: Zimbra's uncomplicated licensing has allowed Sheela Foam to scale up its email system to include more users with the Starter or Professional editions. This helped the company to lower the licensing costs by almost a tenth of what it would have otherwise spent on Microsoft Exchange licences.

A lower total cost of ownership: Sheela Foam was able to drastically reduce costs on licensing, hardware requirements and in-built features, such as storage tiering (HSM), file sharing (briefcase) and backup tools, which would have involved additional costs had the IT team chosen to go with other competitive solutions, including Microsoft Exchange.

Ease of migration: As Zimbra offers native migration tools, Sheela Foam did not require a third-party tool for migrating its users from Microsoft Exchange to Zimbra. **END** 

For more information, trial or demo please contact sales at +91 20 6730 4731 or email india.marketing@zimbra.com